

data sets display key details at a glance, such as size, habitat, distribution, and diet

✓ FEATURE PROFILE

Zooming in on single specimens, feature profiles use close-up photographs to provide in-depth portraits of some of the world's most spectacular species.

each feature includes a side profile of the animal, plant or fungus



TIGER
Panthera tigris

The largest and most striking of the big cats, the tiger is a powerful predator with almost supernatural grace and agility. Its natural range extends from the tropical jungles of Indonesia to the snowy expanses of Siberia, where the largest individuals are found. A full-grown male may weigh anything up to 300 kg (660 lb), but despite the bulk it can leap up to 10 m (33 ft) in a single bound. Adult tigers live alone, except for females with cubs – mothers watch over their young for two years or more, while teaching them vital survival skills.

BROWNISH PURPLE > Unlike most cats, whose pupils contract to vertical slits, tiger pupils are always round. They expand to provide excellent night vision and contract to a pinpoint in bright light.

WHITE EAR FLASH > The prominent white patch on the back of each ear is thought to aid communication. Cubs following their mothers will notice one movement that way signal danger.

SCREELERS > The tiger's vocalizations include long, low, long-drawn-out roars and low-pitched purrs or growls as low as 35 Hz. The tiger's purr is thought to be a signal of contentment.

KILLER IN STRIPES > A tiger's stripes are marked with dark black stripes, which are the tiger's main defense against predators. The white tiger, which is rare, is usually found in captivity and is considered to be a white tiger with black stripes. Globally, there are fewer than 500 left in the wild.

STAR AND SLICE > Post long, canine teeth, tigers have the killing bite to a tiger's prey: black-edged cheek teeth called carnassial teeth, which are used to tear meat.

PAID UP PAW > Tiger paws are more on their front legs than on their back legs. The tiger's paw is held flat and the claws are retracted. The tiger uses it to aid balance when hunting prey or climbing.

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BLUE-AND-YELLOW MACAW
Artibeus macaw
F: Psittacidae

Macaws are large, long-tailed parrots with brightly feathered facial patches. One of two blue and yellow species, this bird comes from northern S. America.

RED-FRONTED MACAW
Artibeus frontalis
F: Psittacidae

This small macaw is restricted to the arid scrub of central Bolivia. Its small population is threatened by habitat loss and wildlife trafficking.

HYACINTH MACAW
Anodorhynchus hyacinthinus
F: Psittacidae

Unlike other macaws, the giant Brazilian parrot has its facial patch reduced to an eye-ring – similar to that of the related Araucaria parakeets.

BURROUING PARAKEET
Cyanolanius burrowingi
F: Psittacidae

A Patagonian relative of macaws, this colonial breeder nests in tunnels in earth banks. It forms faithful pair bonds, unlike most birds.

BLUE-FRONTED PARROT
Amazona aestiva
F: Psittacidae

A member of a large group of mostly green parrots, this species occurs in open forest habitats of central-eastern S. America.

ST VINCENT PARROT
Amazona guildingii
F: Psittacidae

Several Caribbean *Amazona* parrots are faced with extinction. This large species is being conserved by an ongoing breeding programme in its native island of St Vincent.

BLUE-HEADED PARROT
Pionus menstruus
F: Psittacidae

A relative of the *Amazona* parrots, this small parrot is common in lowland forests from Costa Rica to Bolivia.

SCARLET MACAW
Artibeus macaw
F: Psittacidae

Like other macaws, this noisy, flocking bird has a heavy bill for breaking nuts and palm fruit. Its range extends from S. Mexico to C. Brazil.

JANDAYA PARAKEET
Aratinga jandaya
F: Psittacidae

Jandaya is a genus of predominantly green "mini-macaws" found in northeastern Brazil. Some have extensive patches of golden coloration.

MONK PARAKEET
Myiopithecus monachus
F: Psittacidae

This colonial breeder from temperate S. America is the only parrot to build a stick nest, often a large communal structure.

MARQUE-BELLIED PARAKEET
Pyrrhuloxia frontalis
F: Psittacidae

Relatives of *Aratinga*, most *Pyrrhuloxia* parakeets have prominent patches of maroon or red, such as this species from eastern S. America.

DATA MEASUREMENTS

The approximate sizes of the organisms in this book are given in data sets and size boxes. Below is a list of the dimensions used:

MICROSCOPIC LIFE Length

PLANTS
Maximum height above ground, except for:
Height above water rushes
Spread aquatic plants

FUNGI
Width (of widest part), except for:
Height stinkhorn, dog stinkhorn

INVERTEBRATES
Adult body length, except for:
Height sponges, feather stars, common hydra, feather hydroid, pink-hearted hydroid, fire "coral" hydroid, tall anemones, tall corals
Diameter snailfur, blue button, eight-ribbed hydromedusa, cup hydromedusa, freshwater jellyfish
Diameter, excluding spines echinoderms
Diameter of medusa jellyfish
Wingspan butterflies and moths
Length of colony bryozoans
Length of shell molluscs, shelled gastropods
Spread of tentacles octopuses

FISH, AMPHIBIANS, AND REPTILES
Adult body length from head to tail

BIRDS
Adult body length from bill to tail

MAMMALS
Adult body length, excluding tail, except for:
Height to shoulder elephants, apes, even-toed ungulates, odd-toed ungulates

PLANT ICONS

The basic shape of all trees, shrubs, and woody plants is described using one of the following symbols. Herbaceous perennials which die back each winter are not given symbols.

TREES

- Broadly columnar
- Broadly conical
- Large weeping
- Small weeping
- Multi-stemmed tree
- Narrowly columnar, flame-shaped
- Narrowly columnar
- Narrowly conical
- Rounded, broadly columnar
- Rounded, broadly spreading
- Single-stemmed palm
- Multi-stemmed palm, cycad or similar

SHRUBS

- Bushy, mound-forming
- Bushy, suckering
- Compact, bushy
- Erect, tree-like
- Loose, open
- Open, spreading
- Rounded, bushy
- Spreading, prostrate
- Upright
- Upright, arching
- Upright, vigorous, bushy
- Sprawling, climbing

ABBREVIATIONS

SP.: species (used where species name is unknown)
MYA: million years ago
H: hardness of a mineral, measured on the Moh's scale
SG: specific gravity – a mineral's density is measured by comparing its weight to that of an equal volume of water